TOME OF DAMNATION · Vol. 1 · ARTIST PACKET

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CHARACTER LOCKS (read first)

- **Sister Jehra**: ARMORED and HOODED, always (LAW 2026-10-31). Pale, ancient, glowing eyes, battered dark plate, tattered black hood, chains at waist. Never a robed nun. Card: `SISTER_JEHRA_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg` + add hood.
- **Otura**: age-locked. 0 = infant in dark wrap. 8 = small boy, grey tee and shorts, barefoot at home (`OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_8.jpg`). 10 = black jacket and boots (`_10`). 17 = tall teen, messy fro, black long coat, black shirt, skull pendant, boots (`_17`). Never mix the 8 and 17 designs.
- **Yama Amaruk** (the shopkeeper): tall Black man, short hair, tattered dark brown hooded shawl, rune emblem on chest, arm wraps. Yama is NOT Death. **The Grim Reaper / Death** is a separate hooded skeletal figure with a scythe (`THE_GRIM_REAPER_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`). Never merge them.
- **Gozu**: stone GOLEM SENTINEL (canon override). The story text says "juggernaut"; draw the golem.
- **Kano**: ONE horn only, brown wolf tail, hellfire hands, navy bomber jacket, track pants, white sneakers, per card. No hearts motif.
- **Amaya Hasan (17)**: long curly crimson hair, olive green long coat, purple dress, brown boots, satchel. **Kudura Hasan (17)**: spiky red hair, black headband, long red braid, sleeveless torn vest, bare chest, wraps.
- **Eva Vanglory**: inspector, dark hair in bun, long black coat, badge. **Zander Mendez**: fire chief, turnout gear. **Gaya**: chancellor, braided hair, gold hoops, black/purple robe, golden sigil on forearm.
- **The Most High** is always "IT/ITS". No hints at the endgame. No text in the art: all lettering is done in post.
- **Gore**: panels tagged ACTION list the FULL intended gore level. The reference images are softened where the image tool limited them; draw to the GORE note, uncensored.

INTRO · A faint vision in Otura's mind · Year: Unknown

i01 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** A faint vision in Otura's mind. Otura, his age unknown, speaks into the dark about recurring dreams of a vast space, a rift tearing open deep in the universe. The vision terrifies him.
- **Shot:** SPLIT PANEL · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** The Void `THE_VOID_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "I been having these wild dreams for mad long... Its always like this vast space.. Like a rift or something.. Tearing open somewhere deep within the universe.."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "I'm visualizing this shit and it just terrifies the hell outta me.."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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i02 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Sister Jehra (armored, hooded) answers him: he is seeing beyond the Great Rift, where the Grand Architect paints the universe. She tells him he is special.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** single candle, deep shadow; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Sister Jehra `SISTER_JEHRA_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Sister Jehra**: "You see beyond the Great Rift. You see where the Grand Architect paints the universe we know. You see nothing and you see nowhere. You are special."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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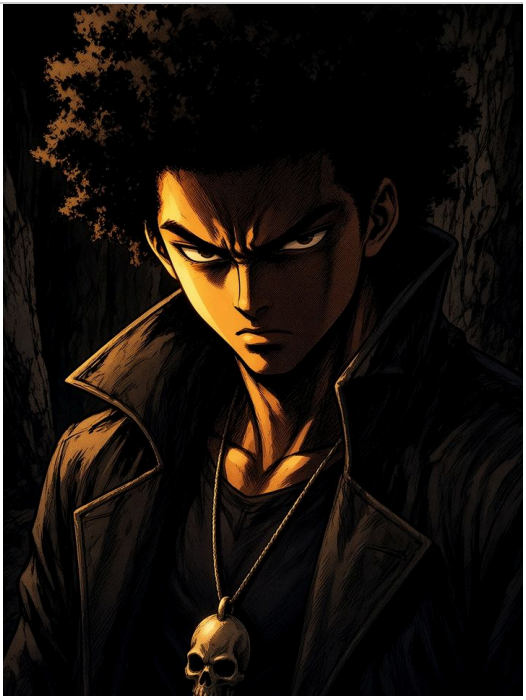
i03 (3:4)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura pushes back, angry and confused: if there is a God, why is all this horrible shit happening?
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** single candle, deep shadow; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "So...my dreams are basically showing me...God? If there's a God....why is all this horrible shit even happening!?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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i04 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Jehra rebukes him: his power did not come from nothing. 'Even Death has to meet his father.' She orders him to sit for the story of the eons-long war.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Sister Jehra `SISTER_JEHRA_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Sister Jehra**: "Do you think your power comes from nothing or on accident boy? Humble yourself. Even Death has to meet his father.."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Sister Jehra**: "Sit boy, I will tell you a story of the war that has raged for eons..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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i05 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Jehra's voice echoes and the cavern trembles. Otura feels the pressure and sheer force of her voice. She describes the Creator's power as beyond fathoming.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Sister Jehra `SISTER_JEHRA_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Sister Jehra's voice echoes loudly, causing trembles throughout the cavern. Otura could feel the pressure and immense power emanating from the vibrations and sheer force of her voice."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Sister Jehra**: "You think you are powerful Otura? The power of our creator is beyond what you can fathom. Imagine having the power to keep a force so massive that its aura alone has the power to erase galaxies."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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i06 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Vision: the Most High (IT/ITS) holds the Void contained in the unseen plains of the Outer Realms, beyond the Rift. The Void is limitless and only grows stronger.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** The Creator `THE_CREATOR_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, The Void `THE_VOID_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The Most High has contained this force we will call "the Void" within the unseen plains of the Outer Realms, beyond the Rift of the Universe, for millennia."
- [CAPTION box]: "The Void's power is limitless and uncontrolled and does not stop, it only grows stronger until it consumes all within its path."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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i07 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Vision: the Void's negative spirit power seeps out of its prison into the universe like a slow leak and poisons everything. Without the Most High, even Jehra would be dust.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The negative spirit power the Void exerts from its prison seeps into the universe like a slow leak...and poisons us all. Without The Most High, even I would be dust or consumed by the Void."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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i08 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Jehra: the Creator is strained. Everyone must play their role, purge this evil, bring balance, and defeat the Void, or it consumes all universes.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Sister Jehra `SISTER_JEHRA_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Sister Jehra**: "Our creator is strained. We must play our roles in this war and stand by our creator with the power we've been instilled with."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Sister Jehra**: "We must help purge this evil and bring balance to the universe with the primary goal of defeating the Void for good in the end."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Sister Jehra**: "If we sit idle, the Void and its abominations will consume all our universes and possibly even our creator."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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i09 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Vision: the self-proclaimed Heralds, worshipped as Gods across the Inner Realms. They are weak, cowardly, and work in the shadows, harvesting spirit power from weaker beings.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "These self-proclaimed...Heralds...they are worshipped as Gods by many beings of the Inner Realms...but, they are weak and they are cowardly."
- [CAPTION box]: "These Heralds are no avatars, they operate in the shadows and harvest vast amounts of spirit power from weaker beings for their own selfish agendas."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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i10 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Jehra contrasts them: a true Avatar seeks balance over power. The Heralds would rather wage their own bitter wars over barren domains.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "An Avatar seeks balance over power, as with balance comes peace, and this is why true Avatars are among the most powerful beings in the universe."
- [CAPTION box]: "The Heralds do not wish to be on the side of The Most High, or simply do not care..They'd rather take their power and wage their own bitter wars over barren domains."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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i11 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Jehra names Otura the true Avatar of Death and Prince of Death's Domain, possibly the crucial piece in ending the war. She offers her life to guide him as his emissary.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** single candle, deep shadow, firelight orange; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Sister Jehra `SISTER_JEHRA_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Sister Jehra**: "Otura, as the true Avatar of Death and Prince of Death's Domain..you may be the most crucial piece towards ending this war for deep reasons I will never understand."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Sister Jehra**: "I will give my life to guide you along your path as your emissary if you will accept me..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

CHAPTER 1 · "Mourning Stars" · The Inner Realms: Purgatory · 2173 CE

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c1_01 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Purgatory, Inner Realms, 2173 CE. The view is darkness: crackling lightning, maroon plasma, blood rain over dead treelines. Lilith watches the Eternal Wars from the shadows of her bloody throne.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** rain, wet sheen; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "While the ancient cosmic entities waged their Eternal Wars, Lilith watched from the shadows of her bloody throne in Purgatory."
- [CAPTION box]: "Purgatory was once a powerful and flourishing kingdom occupied by the outcasted children of the Void. It is now a vast and dark wasteland of ruins."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_02 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The wasteland of Purgatory, once a flourishing kingdom of the Void's outcast children. Destroyed castles and giant dead trees, their leaves soaked by constant blood rain.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** rain, wet sheen; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Destroyed castles, and giant dark trees, most dead or soaked with bloodied leaves from constant blood rain."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_03 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Outside view of Lilith's Castle, then inside: Lilith on her throne at the head of her council table during a war briefing.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** single candle, deep shadow; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Lilith `LILITH_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering:** none (silent panel)
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_04 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Full-panel close-up: a detailed shot of Lilith's grinning face as she vows to eliminate the heirs of the Wardens of Death and all other Heralds, one by one.
- **Shot:** EXTREME CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Lilith `LILITH_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Lilith**: "We will eliminate the heirs of the Wardens of Death and all other Heralds...one-by-one"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_05 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Lilith in her own domain, vile and unfiltered. To the other Heralds she shows a mask of neutrality, but her followers know what she is truly capable of.
- **Shot:** SPLIT PANEL · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Lilith `LILITH_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Lilith hides her ambitions behind a mask of neutrality when in the presence of the other Heralds. But within her Domain, she is vile and unfiltered."
- [CAPTION box]: "Her followers know how deceiving she can be and the true evils the Queen of Purgatory is capable of."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_06 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Full page: a bird's-eye establishing shot of Empire City at night, 2175 CE. Neon skyscrapers crowd grimy low-rises, heavy rain falls, wet streets reflect the glow, and hover vehicles run on light-lanes. Humanity is unaware of the cosmic war.
- **Shot:** BIRD'S-EYE WIDE · **Lighting/mood:** neon purple/cyan, wet reflections, cold moonlight, rain, wet sheen; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Earth: Empire City, night · 2175 CE"
- [CAPTION box]: "The peace these beings felt was just a fragile illusion. The humans were a mere hum of existence, blissfully unaware of this cosmic war bleeding into their reality."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_07 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The Empire City Slums: markets, apartments, homeless people. No flying cars here.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** rain, wet sheen; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Earth: Empire City Slums"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_08 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The outside of a small slum apartment. Inside live eight-year-old Otura and his mother Avani, whose whole world revolves around her son.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** warm lamp; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (8) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_8.jpg`, Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "In a small apartment in the heart of the Empire slums lived eight-year-old Otura, who lived within a world defined by his mother Avani's love."
- [CAPTION box]: "Having endured and overcome her own grief and traumas in the past, Avani's world now revolved around her son; he was her only light."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_09 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Late night. Avani, who has survived her own grief, washes dishes while Otura laughs in the background. She senses a subtle wrongness in the air she cannot name.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** rain, wet sheen; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "His laughter was a ward against the approaching darkness she could feel but could not name. It was like a subtle wrongness in the air that settled like dust on the core of her soul."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_10 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura on the couch, giggling at his favorite live streamer on his tablet. Avani looks over: it's late. He begs for 15 more minutes.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (8) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_8.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Avani looks over at Otura, it's late."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Avani**: "Otura, it's time for bed."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Aw mommy, can I watch for 15 more minutes please?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_11 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Avani at the sink, smiling over her shoulder as she bargains: 10 more minutes, then teeth. Otura agrees.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Avani**: "How about 10 more minutes...and then we go and brush your teeth?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Ok, sounds good!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_12 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The bathroom. Otura is too short for the mirror, so he stands on a step stool to brush his teeth while Avani helps him.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (8) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_8.jpg`
- **Lettering:** none (silent panel)
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_13 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura's room. Avani tucks him in and kisses his forehead, gentle and soft. They exchange goodnights and I-love-yous.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (8) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_8.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Avani**: "Goodnight Otura, sleep well son, I love you."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Goodnight mommy, love you!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_14 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Avani closes his door and lies down on the living-room couch. She tucks herself in and closes her eyes.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** rain, wet sheen; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Avani leaves Otura's room and closes the door behind her. She lies down, tucks herself in and closes her eyes for rest."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_15 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Smoke and heat jolt Avani awake. She rushes off the couch toward Otura's room.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange, embers; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The smell of smoke in the air and the heat of fire abruptly wakes Avani up."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_16 (9:16) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Avani rams her shoulder into Otura's melted, burning door, screaming as it sears her skin. Otura screams from inside. Rain and lightning batter the window.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "She screams in agony as soon as her skin touches the hot, melted door."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Avani**: "Son? Otura! Otura!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Mommy! What's going on??! Help me, it's so hot, there's fire and I'm scared!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Avani**: "It'll be okay son, I'm going to get you out!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_17 (9:16) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** A grim voice chills her. The demon, its flesh rotten, burnt, and bloody, walks slowly toward her.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Liliths Demon `LILITHS_DEMON_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "A grim, dark voice quickly sent chills through Avani's body, making her feel cold despite the raging flames."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Demon**: "Stop it you disgusting weak human..this is pathetic"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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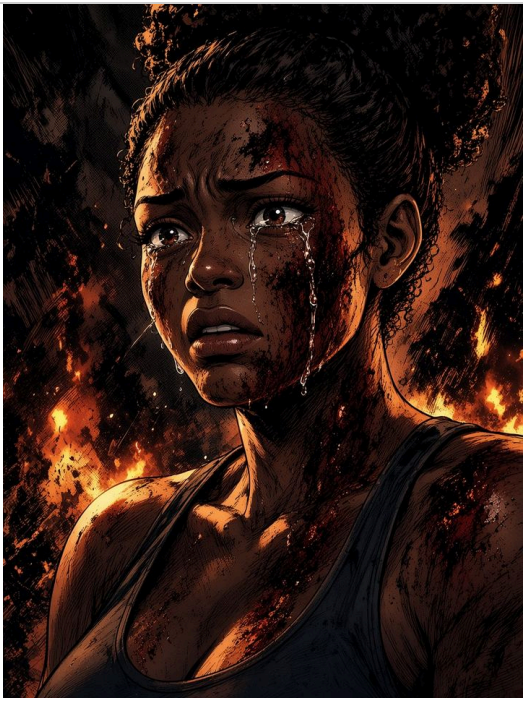
c1_18 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Avani trembles in body and voice. The room goes eerily quiet, and Otura's cries are drowned out by the storm and the flames.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange, embers; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Avani**: "Otura... My boy.."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Avani**: "Wha-what are you..please just leave us alone!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.



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c1_19 (16:9) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** The demon engulfs Avani in an unknown power and paralyzes her instantly. Frozen, she begs it to take her instead. It mocks her.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Liliths Demon `LILITHS_DEMON_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Avani is immediately paralyzed."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Demon**: "I am your end...you and your abomination of a son will die here tonight."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Avani**: "Please whoever you are, please I beg of you just let him go! Take me instead!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Demon**: "Take you? What would I do with a human whore!?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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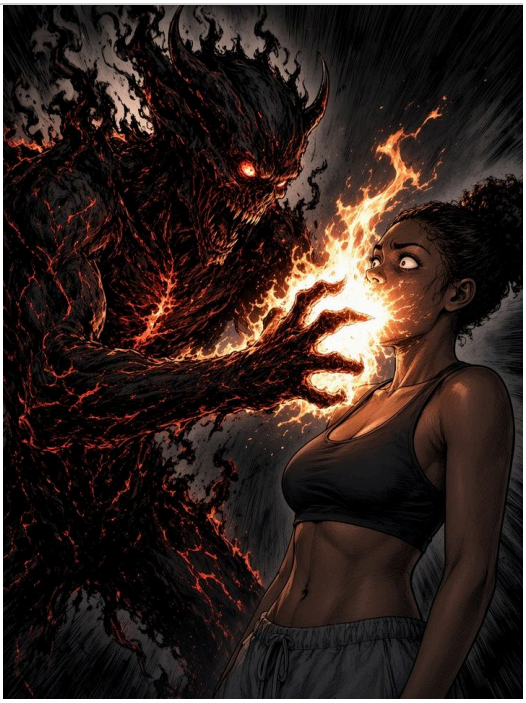
c1_20 (3:4) · ACTION



- **Beat (from story prose):** Mid-plea, the demon brands Avani's mouth with flame, searing her lips shut. Muffled sobs follow; she knows it's too late.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Liliths Demon `LILITHS_DEMON_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Avani**: "Please! Don't! -"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Demon**: "SILENCE FILTHY MAGGOT!"
- [CAPTION box]: "In an instant, the Demon brands Avani's mouth with a flame so hot, it seared her lips shut."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c1_21 (3:4) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura's screams fade to soft cries, then to silence, and Avani falls silent with him. The demon looms, deciding which one to eat first.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Liliths Demon `LILITHS_DEMON_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Otura's screams turned into soft cries, and as his soft cries went completely silent, so did she."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Demon**: "Ah, that's... Now which one of you will I eat first?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c1_22 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Just as it moves to consume them, the demon vanishes. The flames die almost instantly into a deafening silence and crackling embers.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Just as the demon prepared to consume Avani and Otura, he vanished into thin air."
- [CAPTION box]: "The demon is gone and the flames ceased almost instantly. The silence that followed was more deafening than the roar of the flames."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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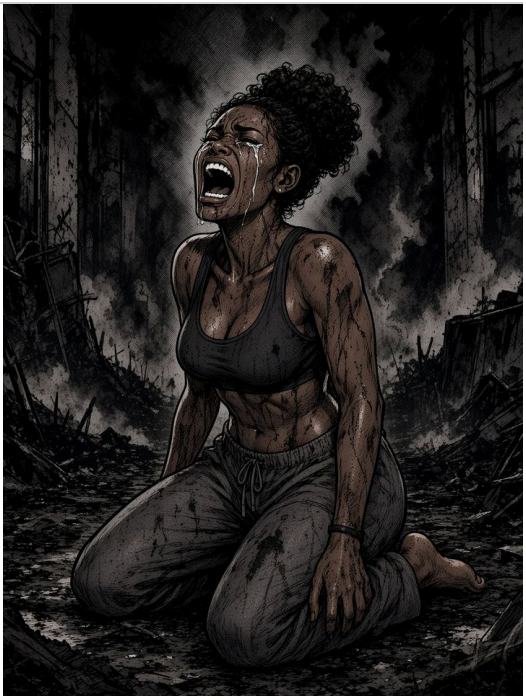
c1_23 (3:4)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Avani is still frozen, her lips sealed, tears cutting through the soot on her burned skin. Otura is gone. The demon's last words echo: this is not over.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Avani `AVANI_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Her Otura, her sweet, innocent boy, was gone."
-
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c1_24 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The paralysis lifts and Avani stumbles to her feet. Consumed by grief and believing she failed her only son, she takes her own life with a knife to the throat. Handle with restraint.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** rain, wet sheen; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Avani, fueled by a grief-stricken rage and a mother's unwavering love, felt as if she had nothing else to live for."
- [CAPTION box]: "Avani took her own life with a slash of a knife to the throat, she had failed her only son..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

THE WAR OF THE DEAD · 2176 CE

---

w01 (9:16) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** 2176 CE. Satan and the Legion of Hell, the Red Cabal, and fallen angels ally against the House of Death.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Satan `SATAN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "In the year 2176 CE, Satan & The Legion of Hell, The Red Cabal, and various enemies and fallen angels have allied to stand against the House of Death."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

w02 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The House of Death: the followers, family, and descendants of the Grim Reaper. Guarded and ruthless, their power grows with every soul that prays to them.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** The Grim Reaper `THE_GRIM_REAPER_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The House of Death are the followers, family members, and descendants of The Grim Reaper. The members of Death's Domain are on guard and ruthless."
- [CAPTION box]: "For every soul within the Inner Realms that pledges allegiance to or prays to the House of Death, Death's Domain increases in power."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

w03 (3:4) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** The enemy forces seal a blood pact: the Pact of Black Thorns.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** single candle, deep shadow; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "These forces against The House of Death have formed a blood pact called The Pact of Black Thorns."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

w04 (16:9) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** After the deaths of Otura and Avani, the House of Death slaughters every demonic opponent in sight.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "After the deaths of Otura and Avani, the House of Death slaughtered any demonic opposition in sight."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

w05 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The Black Thorns' aim: kill Death and consume his primeval power, eliminate the other Wardens and Heralds, and overpower the Most High (IT). Some even wish to free the Void.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** The Void `THE_VOID_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The Black Thorns are seeking to kill Death and consume him and his primeval power, and then they plan to eliminate all other Wardens and Heralds to gain the strength they need to overpower The Most High and its allies in the Eternal War, some even wish to free The Void."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

CHAPTER 2 · Born Again · Somewhere far away on Earth · 2185 CE · Resurrection count: 1 · Otura's age: 0

---

c2_01 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Somewhere far away on Earth, 2185 CE, resurrection count 1. A mystic portal of black and purple opens in the sky, shrouded in fog: Otura's first rebirth.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "For the first time in Otura's life 100 years later, he is resurrected."
- [CAPTION box]: "His rebirth seems to be in the form of a mystic purple, with a tone of black and purple hue, shrouded by fog."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_02 (16:9) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Baby Otura falls from the portal and hits the earth with a massive impact.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (infant) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_0.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Otura falls from this portal in the sky, causing a massive impact on the earth ground below."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_03 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The smoking crater in the dry desert of Pangea, far from Empire City. Otura is unfazed and unharmed.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (infant) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_0.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Otura is unfazed and unharmed. Otura is rebirthed in the dry desert of Pangea, far away from Empire City."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_04 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama Amaruk, owner of the Emporium, teleports in almost instantly. He tells the baby he crossed countless timelines to be here. Otura giggles.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (infant) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_0.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Ah, finally the time has come. Baby Otura, I've been pulled through countless timelines and dimensions to be here for you today."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Boo boo!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_05 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama admits he didn't expect a baby and asks whether Otura remembers his past life. Otura smiles: 'Aha!'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (infant) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_0.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Well... to be fair I didn't expect to be retrieving a baby. I wonder, do you have memories of your past life, little one?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Aha!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_06 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama notes it took exactly 10 years for Otura to resurrect. He vows to protect him, as Avani would have wanted. Otura announces: 'POO!'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (infant) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_0.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I'll be taking care of you from here on out Otura. I will give my life to protect yours, as Avani would have wanted."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "POO!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_07 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Comic beat: Yama finds the source of the rancid smell, disgusted.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (infant) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_0.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Ah... so that's what that rancid smell was... what do souls even eat to have feces this disgusting?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_08 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama senses many presences closing in, holds Otura, and prepares to teleport back to the Emporium.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (infant) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_0.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "No matter, I sense many presences approaching. We must leave now, Otura."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_09 (16:9) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Two mysterious men intercept him. Holding the baby, Yama quickly and brutally kills both, then teleports away safely.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Yama is intercepted by two mysterious men and engages in a quick battle, swiftly eliminating both men and teleporting safely."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_10 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The back of the Emporium: a sprawling space of artifacts from forgotten civilizations, future tech, and inexplicable objects, all curated and protected by Yama. Otura's playground.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** warm lamp; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Artifacts from forgotten civilizations, technological marvels from the future, and objects that defied explanation, all carefully curated and protected by Yama."
- [CAPTION box]: "This was Otura's playground."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_11 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Growth montage: Yama weaves history, philosophy, and combat into their daily routines, and Otura grows rapidly.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (infant) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_0.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Yama began Otura's training by subtly weaving lessons on history, philosophy, and combat into their daily routines."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_12 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Growth montage: over 10 years Yama trains and protects Otura and teaches him about the Eternal War, the thinning Veil, and his powers, keeping the full truth of his destiny hidden.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (8) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_8.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "For 10 years, Yama trained and protected Otura."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_13 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura, curious, asks about his parents, especially his father. He believes Avani was killed by a demon the night he was born. Yama knows this is a lie and keeps it, watching for signs of returning memory.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (10) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_10.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "As Otura grew, so did his curiosity. He would often ask Yama about his parents, especially his father, whom he had never known."
- [CAPTION box]: "For now, all Otura knows about his mother, Avani, is that she was killed by a demon the night he was born. Yama knows this is a lie, but he keeps this lie for as long as he possibly can."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_14 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The Emporium, 2195 CE, Otura is 10. Draven, sent on behalf of Death, lets himself in uninvited. Yama is dry about his manners.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Draven `DRAVEN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The Emporium, Empire City · 2195 CE · Otura's age: 10"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "Mind if I let myself in, Yama?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "You never were one to have manners, Draven."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_15 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Draven asks about the boy. Otura is in the observatory studying. Draven asks for Yama's logs and whether the boy is regaining memories.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Draven `DRAVEN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "Well you know I like to get straight to the point... How's the boy?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "He is well, he's in the observatory studying right now... Did he send you?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "Death said you were concerned the boy is regaining memories. Have you evaluated what he might know, and where are your logs, Yama?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_16 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama snaps that Death called it impossible without the pendant: the boy is just a genius. Draven jokes he's the Grim Reaper's kid. Yama keeps a straight face.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Do you really have to be up my ass right now... I brought this up with him and he said it would be an impossible occurrence without the pendant. The boy is just gifted... He's a genius."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "Well... He is the GRIM REAPER's KID... haha..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_17 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama tries to show him out. Draven reminds him what's at stake.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Well, is there anything else you needed or are you ready to leave?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "Now Yama, don't get all riled up. We both know what's at stake if things go wrong."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Yes, I know."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_18 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Their standing order: kill anyone within 500 meters of the boy on sight, unless they hold a Sigil of Death. Draven's chuckle seems to vibrate the air.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Draven `DRAVEN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "Also, we are still under orders to kill anyone who comes within 500 meters of the boy, on sight."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Yes Draven, so long as they don't hold a Sigil of Death."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "Of course Yama, we won't just kill anyone we want... That's not how we run things!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Right..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_19 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Draven's form shimmers and dissolves into light. With a sharper edge he warns Yama not to deviate from the plan, then vanishes.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Draven `DRAVEN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "VERY WELL! Keep us notified of the boy's progress and mishaps should there be any... Goodbye for now!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "And Yama..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Draven**: "Do not deviate from the plan. The consequences would be catastrophic, not just for Earth, but for the entire realm."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_20 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama alone, looking up at the ceiling with a heavy sigh, visibly upset: 'The plan... Right.'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "The plan... Right."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_21 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Ten-year-old Otura looks up from his books and meets Yama's eyes with an innocent smile. Yama feels a pang of guilt.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (10) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_10.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Otura, who was busy reading books in the Emporium, looked towards Yama, his innocent eyes meeting Yama's with a smile."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c2_22 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama murmurs a promise to make him strong and keep him safe, even if he dies trying.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Don't worry, little one."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I'll make you strong and keep you safe... even if I die trying."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

CHAPTER 3 · The City That Seems Alive · Empire City · 2202 CE · Otura's age: 17

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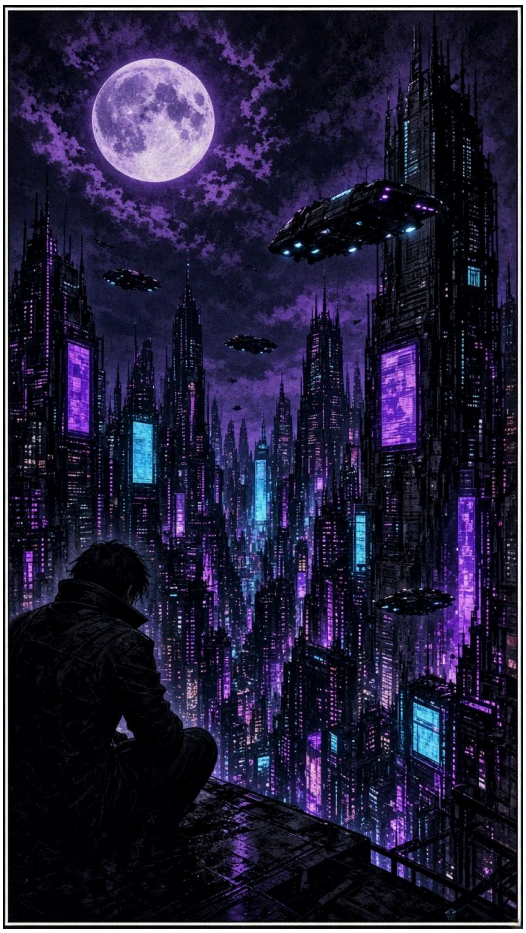
c3_01 (9:16)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Empire City, 2202 CE. Purple and cyan neon on towering skyscrapers, hover vehicles humming, billboards beeping. The usual night.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** neon purple/cyan, wet reflections, cold moonlight; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Purple and cyan neon lights danced along the towering skyscrapers, casting vibrant hues from the top of the new buildings down to the bustling streets below."
- [CAPTION box]: "It was the usual night in Empire City."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_02 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Seventeen-year-old Otura walks the streets alone with headphones in, dressed in clothes that mix style and utility, his messy fro in the wind.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** neon purple/cyan, wet reflections; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Amid this multicolored symphony, 17-year-old Otura navigated the labyrinth of streets in his neighborhood, a lone figure searching for purpose beneath the canopy of stars."
- [CAPTION box]: "His messy fro danced in the wind, an untamed rebellion against conformity."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

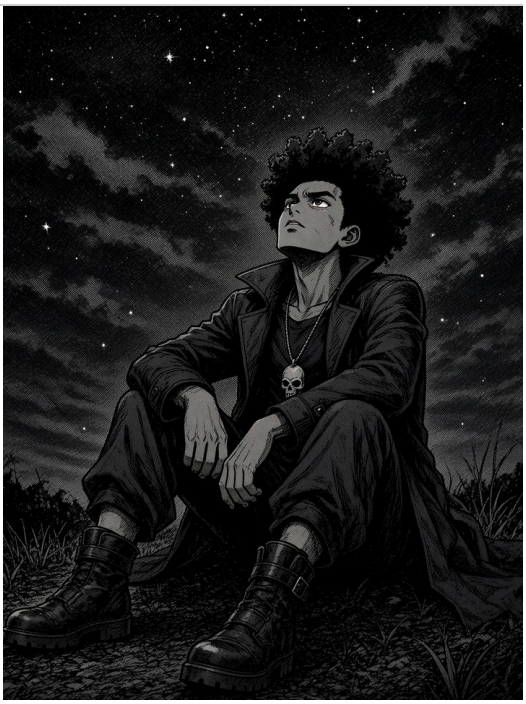
---

c3_03 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** A park in the heart of the city. Towering trees blend with the city lights, and the paths glow with bioluminescent flora. He finds a secluded spot.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "His path led him to a park nestled within the heart of the city."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_04 (3:4)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura gazes up at the stars and sighs: 17 years, and he feels he has no purpose.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "17 years on this Earth... I'm surprised I've gotten this far."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Everyone seems to have their lives all figured out... Meanwhile I just feel like I have no purpose."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_05 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** At a tranquil river reflecting the moon, Otura mutters that it's just him and his thoughts against the world.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** cold moonlight; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Most times, it's just me and my thoughts against the world..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_06 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Staring at the water, he jokes darkly about dying and going to hell.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "What's the point in any of this if I'm just going to die and go to hell anyway..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Yeah right, who'd wanna be stuck in hell after experiencing this?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_07 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura lays it all out to the universe: 'What is my purpose?' A pause, then a whisper: 'Are you even listening...?'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Yo God, Creator, Universe... whatever you are... What is my purpose?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Are you even listening...?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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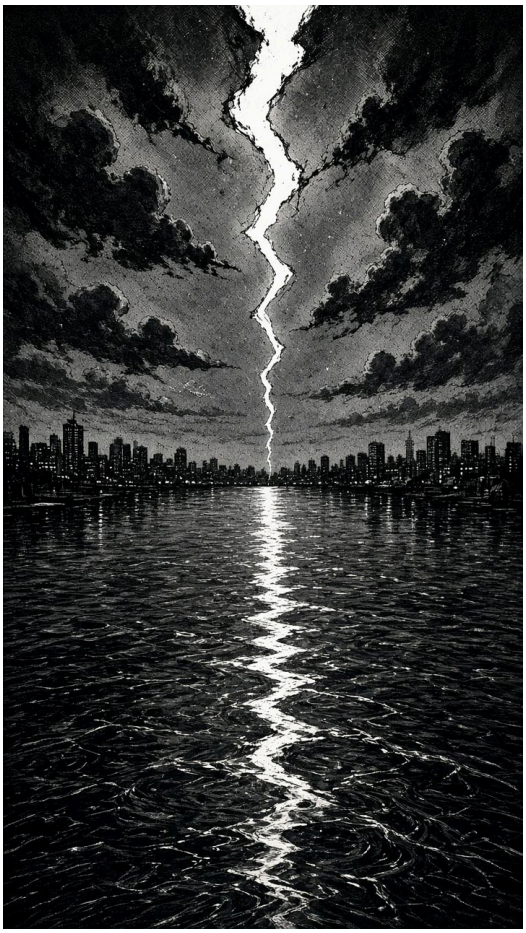
c3_08 (9:16)



- **Beat (from story prose):** The city goes far away, as if someone turned the world down. A low hum rises from under his feet. The water trembles, and for a blink the reflected sky looks torn open down the middle.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The city went quiet. Not silent, just far away, like somebody turned the whole world down."
- [CAPTION box]: "The water trembled, and for a blink the reflection of the sky looked torn open down the middle. Then it was just the moon again."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_09 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura pulls out one earbud, unsettled: why does that feel so familiar? The hum is gone, the city is loud again, and nothing answers.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- THOUGHT balloon: "What the hell was that... Why does that feel so familiar?"
- [CAPTION box]: "The hum was gone. The city came back, loud as ever. Nothing answered him."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_10 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Leaving the park, Otura is stopped by Amaya, an eccentric Hyldryn girl who lives near the Emporium. Kudura is gaming at Arkada.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Otura! Wait up!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Huh? Oh... Hey Amaya. What are you doing here?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Just taking a stroll... figured I'd go to the park while Kudura games at Arkada."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_11 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura warns her not to be in the park alone this late. She can handle herself, Kudura always rescues her, and she's more worried about him.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** neon purple/cyan, wet reflections; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "I see... well you shouldn't be at the park alone this late, Amaya."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "I can handle myself, Otura. Besides, you know Kudura always comes to the rescue if I'm in any trouble!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Besides... I'm more worried about you. Why are you out here all by yourself?!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_12 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** He was just heading back to the Emporium. She invites herself along, and they walk and talk together.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** neon purple/cyan, wet reflections; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "This is my favorite place to come to and think... I was just leaving. I'm headed back to The Emporium."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Can I come along to help? By the time we finish, Kudura should be calling me."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Cool with me, let's go."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_13 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The Emporium door swings open in the moonlight onto a realm of history and secrets. Yama greets them with a nod.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** cold moonlight; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Yama's Emporium"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Evenin', children, how are things?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Hey Yama... Things are well I guess - Amaya is here too!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Greetings Mr. Amaruk!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_14 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama waves off the cleaning: he has books for them. Otura groans. Yama grins: these are scrolls, grimoires, and mystic texts the council can't decipher.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Oh! Otura, never mind the cleaning, I have a few books for you both to read."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Books? Are you kidding...? I don't feel like reading right now."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "They're more than just books actually... They're scrolls from ages past, grimoires, mystic texts. The council can't decipher 'em, so they sent them to me..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_15 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura, intrigued, raises an eyebrow: isn't it irresponsible to hand them out? Yama deflects.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "So... It's pretty irresponsible of you to let us have them, isn't it?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "...Eh... Let's just say they're old to someone like myself and new to someone like yourself."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_16 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Amaya is drawn to an ancient grimoire written in an unknown language. It feels like it's calling to her.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "It almost feels as if it's calling out to me..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Well there's a reason for that, Amaya."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Huh? What do you mean?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_17 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama names it: the Tome of Damnation, vampiric spells created by her Hyldryn bloodline. Amaya is thrilled but uneasy. Otura asks why the council had it.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "That grimoire is the Tome of Damnation, it's a powerful tome of vampiric spells said to have been created by your bloodline, the Hyldryn vampires."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "The Tome of Damnation? That sounds so cool... but I don't understand, it sounds dangerous."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Also, why did the council have this book?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_18 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama: it's dangerous, but she can handle it, and the council's business is none of Otura's concern. Otura isn't convinced.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "It is very dangerous, but you can handle it Amaya, and Otura, what the council does is none of your concern."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Well it just doesn't make much sense to me... This powerful tome and you just hand it over to Amaya like it's nothing..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_19 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama explains it was excavated in Idol City and only the Hyldryn bloodline can read it. Amaya is one of the strongest Hyldryn he knows.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Well, the excavation team got these items from a project in Idol City. The High Council tasked me to sort them, however, I wouldn't be able to decipher that book."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "The Tome of Damnation is only able to be read by the Hyldryn bloodline. Amaya is one of the strongest Hyldryn vampires I know... and she's right here!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_20 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura asks if he even cares if she gets hurt. Yama asks for their trust. Amaya trusts him and thanks him for the book.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Well what if she gets hurt, do you even care?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Of course I do Otura, but I urge you both to trust me."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Well of course I trust you Mr. Amaruk. Otura is just overthinking things, I'm sure it'll be fine... Thank you for the book!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_21 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama asks after Kudura. Amaya realizes he never called. The Emporium's ward of death blocks her phone and her sibling-sense.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "No worries Amaya. By the way, where is your brother Kudura? I also have something I'd like to share with him."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Oh! You just reminded me! Kudura never called... He's at Arkada!"
- [CAPTION box]: "The Emporium has a ward of death, which nullifies all frequencies outside of the House of Death's."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_22 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama has Otura walk her toward Arkada. Otura agrees.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Ah Arkada. Well Otura can walk you back that way so you aren't alone. You should be able to call your brother once you exit The Emporium."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "If it isn't a bother, would you, Otura?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Of course."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c3_23 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The door closes behind them. Yama's grin fades, and he stands alone among his relics, staring at the empty spot where the book had been.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The door closed behind them, and Yama's grin faded."
- [CAPTION box]: "He stood alone among his relics, staring at the empty spot where the book had been."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

CHAPTER 4 · Sibling-Sense

---

c4_01 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The moment Amaya steps outside, she freezes: Kudura's in trouble.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Amaya? Are you okay?!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Kudura's in trouble!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Wh-What do you mean?!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_02 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Outside the ward she can finally feel him in pain. Otura tells her to lead the way.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "I couldn't sense him inside of the Emporium but now that I'm outside I can feel it... My brother needs my help!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "OK, let's get to Kudura now, can you lead the way?!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Follow me, I can sense him in pain!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_03 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** They race through the night toward Arkada. Her senses pull them into a dark alleyway nearby.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** neon purple/cyan, wet reflections; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Amaya and Otura rush to Arkada. Her senses lead her to a dark alleyway near Arkada."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_04 (9:16) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** In the alley the Draculian Assassin pummels Kudura, punching and kicking him while demanding 'WHERE IS IT?'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** rain, wet sheen; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Draculian Assassin `DRACULIAN_ASSASSIN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Assassin**: "WHERE IS IT?"
-
- [SPEECH balloon] **Assassin**: "TELL ME WHAT YOU KNOW YOU BRAT!"
- SFX: "PUNCH. PUNCH. KICK."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_05 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Amaya screams at him to leave her brother alone. Otura shouts too.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "HEY STOP THAT! THAT'S MY BROTHER, LEAVE HIM ALONE!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Hey, get away from him right now!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_06 (3:4) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Kudura on the ground, badly beaten, bloody and bruised.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Kudura is badly beaten, bloody and bruised."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_07 (3:4) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** The Assassin sizes them up (the sister, and some other runt), shrugs off killing family and friends, and pounces at Otura and Amaya.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Draculian Assassin `DRACULIAN_ASSASSIN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Assassin**: "This must be the sister... but who is this other runt?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Assassin**: "They didn't say we'd be killing family and friends tonight..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Assassin**: "Ah what's it matter anyway... prepare to die!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_08 (16:9) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama appears out of nowhere and closes in to deflect the strike with his sword. CLANG.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Draculian Assassin `DRACULIAN_ASSASSIN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Yama appears out of what seems to be nowhere."
-
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_09 (9:16) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama counters at blurring speed, his eyes fierce. Steel clashes under the faint moonlight, casting long shadows on the walls.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** cold moonlight; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Draculian Assassin `DRACULIAN_ASSASSIN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Yama's eyes gleamed with a fierce intensity as he countered the assassin's attack, his movements a blur of speed and precision."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_10 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura stares in awe: it's the first time he's seen Yama fight with killing intent. He and Amaya run to Kudura while the duel continues.
- **Shot:** WIDE · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Otura's eyes widened in awe of Yama's strength. This is the first time he's seen Yama fight with killing intent."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_11 (16:9) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** The outclassed Assassin tries to flee. Yama throws his sword through the Assassin's calf, pinning his leg to the ground. The Assassin screams.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Draculian Assassin `DRACULIAN_ASSASSIN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Assassin**: "Arghhh! You bastard!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_12 (3:4) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama stands over him: one chance. Who are you, and why attack these children?
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I'll only ask you this once, you have one chance to answer, don't blow it... Who are you and why did you attack these children?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_13 (3:4) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** The Assassin spits blood and refuses: their mission is only a partial failure with his death. Yama catches the word 'our.'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Draculian Assassin `DRACULIAN_ASSASSIN_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Assassin**: "Why would I tell you anything, you'll kill me anyway! Besides, our mission is only a partial failure with my death..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Our? So there's more of you... Of course."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_14 (9:16) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama beheads the Assassin and absorbs his spirit power. He wonders what a 400-year-old Draculian assassin meant by 'partial failure.'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Yama quickly beheads the Assassin and absorbs his spirit power."
- THOUGHT balloon: "A 400-year-old Draculian assassin... what did he mean by their mission is only a partial failure?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_15 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Amaya begs Mr. Amaruk for help. Yama asks them to step away from Kudura.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Mr. Amaruk, help! Kudura is badly injured!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Can you help him?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Please step away from him."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_16 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama examines the jagged gash on Kudura's chest and feels his life force teetering. He weaves a pattern with his fingers and channels the absorbed power into him: essence transference.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "This is a portion of the power from that assassin, I'm transferring it to you, Kudura."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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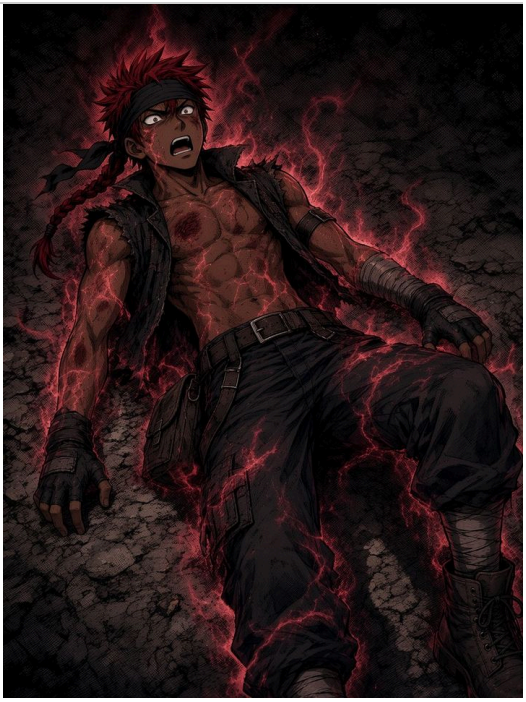
c4_17 (3:4) · ACTION



- **Beat (from story prose):** The Draculian power surges through Kudura's veins, mending his wounds. His chest heaves as his strength returns, multiplied.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Kudura's chest heaved with a deep, shuddering breath as he felt his strength and vitality return, multiplied manyfold."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_18 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Kudura, aglow with awe, thanks Yama and owes him a debt. Yama softens, grips his shoulder, and wants nothing but their safety. Amaya, pale, nods her gratitude.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "Yama... thank you."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "I owe you a debt I fear I can never fully repay."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "You owe me nothing, Kudura."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I only want to see you, Amaya, and Otura safe. That is all the repayment I need."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_19 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama calls to Otura, who is shaken by what he saw. They'll walk home: Yama can't teleport them all.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Otura, we're taking them home."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Of course, let's go."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Yama, how'd you get here so quickly?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I teleported, but I don't have enough power right now to teleport all of us. We'll have to walk from here."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_20 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Walking home, Kudura feels great. Amaya asks why the maniac was after him. He was jumped leaving Arkada.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "It's not a problem, we're used to this walk... and I'm feeling great now thanks to you."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Kudura... I'm so glad you're okay, but why was that maniac after you?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "I'm not sure... I was leaving Arkada and he jumped me by surprise, or else I would've had him."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_21 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Amaya realizes it was the Tome. Yama agrees: their whole Hyldryn family is now a target. Otura blurts that he knew it was a bad idea. Yama silences him.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "A book? Yama...? Could it be he was looking for the Tome of Damnation?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "It seems likely. They seem to sense that the book is in Empire City, that means I must protect your family, as you will all be a target being of Hyldryn bloodline."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "I knew it wasn't a good idea to give Amaya that book!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Quiet Otura, now isn't the time."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_22 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Kudura asks why they want it. It holds great power for vampires, greater for Hyldryn. Amaya fears for their parents.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "This book... Why do they want it so bad?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "It holds great power to vampires and even greater power to Hyldryn vampires."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Kudura... our parents could be in danger..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_23 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Wide shot of the dark alley. The air turns stifling, then the silence breaks: sirens.
- **Shot:** WIDE · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The cool night air suddenly feels stifling. A heavy silence falls over the group, broken only by the distant, rhythmic hum of the city."
-
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_24 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Close-up: Kudura's eyes widen as the sirens grow louder.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "I have this terrible feeling..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_25 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Amaya looks up: the sky over the distant buildings glows an unnatural orange. Elmwood Avenue, their home.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "I can feel it too... The direction of those sirens... Elmwood Avenue!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c4_26 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Cop cars and fire trucks blur past the alley mouth in red and blue. Amaya and Kudura sprint ahead despite Yama's warning, and Yama and Otura chase after them.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange, embers, emergency red/blue; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "We have to get home now!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Hold on! Stay with me, it's not safe!"
- [CAPTION box]: "Yama and Otura sprint after them into the chaos."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

CHAPTER 5 · Ashes and Echoes · Elmwood Avenue

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c5_01 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Elmwood Avenue: the Hasan home engulfed in flames, the night thick with smoke.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange, embers; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The night air on Elmwood Avenue was thick with smoke, illuminated by the fiery blaze that engulfed a home in its destructive embrace."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

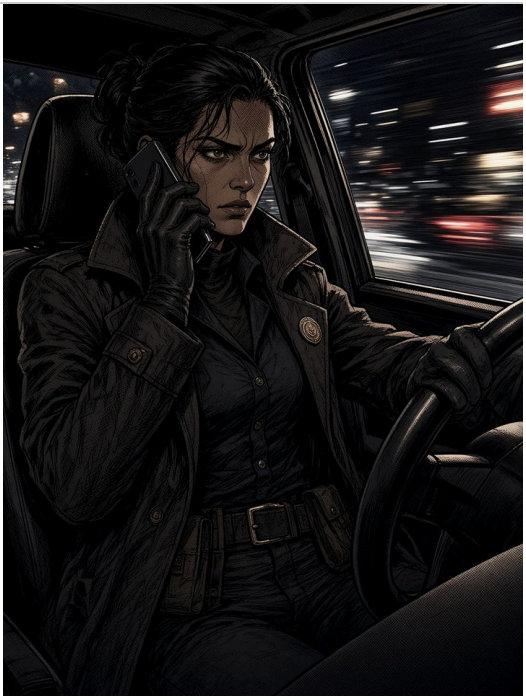
---

c5_02 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Chief Zander Mendez steps out of his vehicle, grim, and orders an evacuation and a perimeter.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange, embers; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Zander Mendez `ZANDER_MENDEZ_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Chief Mendez**: "Evacuate the area! Get everyone to safety and establish a perimeter. We need to contain this before it spreads any further!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_03 (3:4)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Inspector Eva Vanglory speeds through the city and takes a cryptic phone call en route.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Are you sure?... Hmm, that's interesting. I'll keep that in mind. I'll report back soon, bye."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c5_04 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Vanglory arrives amid the firefighting. She and Mendez exchange a few words: a hard fire to contain, and they hope there are no casualties.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange, embers; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Zander Mendez `ZANDER_MENDEZ_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Chief Mendez**: "This one's a mess, Vanglory, it's been a real challenge to contain."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Always the case with fires like these, Chief."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Chief Mendez**: "Agreed, hopefully there's no casualties..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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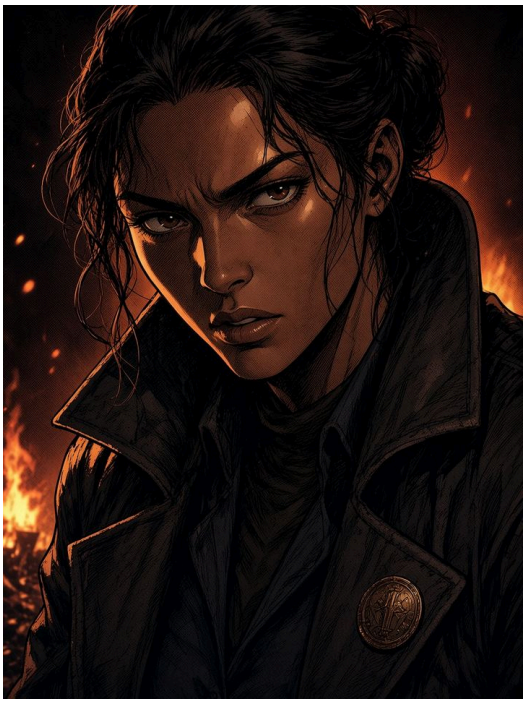
c5_05 (3:4)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Vanglory shares her intel quietly: this is the home of the last Hyldryn bloodline, basically royalty. Keep it quiet.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "I hope so too, I got a call on my way here. I received intel that this is the home of the last of the Hyldryn bloodline."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Chief Mendez**: "Wow, Hyldryn vampires right here in Empire City? That's pretty crazy."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Yeah, keep this intel to yourself for now... We need to pray there's no casualties here, this family is basically royalty."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_06 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** As the blaze subsides, Vanglory spots an anomaly: one section of the house completely untouched, as if protected.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Zander Mendez `ZANDER_MENDEZ_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Look at this, Chief. An entire section of the house seems to have escaped the fire's wrath. It's like the flames deliberately avoided it."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Chief Mendez**: "That's unlike any fire I've seen. It's as if this area was protected by some force."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_07 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** In the charred remains: a body, unidentifiable and frozen in a gruesome state, with an emptied gem amulet beside it.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Chief, we've got a body here, unidentifiable, and look, an emptied gem amulet. This situation just took a darker turn."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_08 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Mendez asks whether it's murder, robbery, or arson. Vanglory vows to investigate. Where is the rest of the family?
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Zander Mendez `ZANDER_MENDEZ_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Chief Mendez**: "We need to get to the bottom of this, Inspector. Were they murdered, is this a robbery or arson?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Trust me we'll thoroughly investigate this... I assume this is one of the family members, but where are the rest of them?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

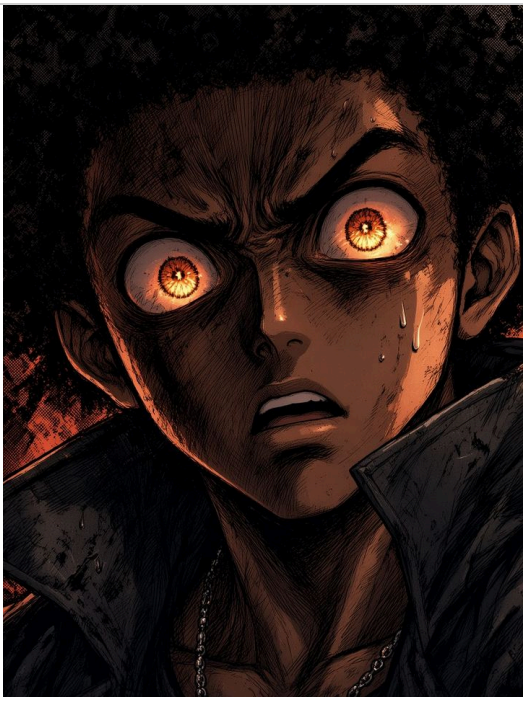
---

c5_09 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The four arrive among the flashing lights and onlookers. Amaya whispers 'No...'. Kudura surges forward, and Yama's arm catches him across the chest: 'You can't.'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** emergency red/blue; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "No..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "MOM! DAD!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Wait!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "You can't."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_10 (3:4)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Close-up: Otura frozen behind them, pupils dilated, flames reflected in his eyes. The smoke hits him like a blow.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The acrid smell of smoke hit Otura like a physical blow."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_11 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Flashback glimpse: a blurred, fiery room and a melted door handle. A child's voice cries 'Mommy!'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- THOUGHT balloon: "Mommy! What's going on?! Help me I'm scared!! It's so hot..."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_12 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura stumbles back, clutching his chest, with phantom pain in his lungs. He hears a woman's muffled screams, a memory that shouldn't be there.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "A phantom pain rips through his lungs. He can hear a woman's muffled, agonizing screams echoing in his mind, a memory that wasn't supposed to be there."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_13 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** He forces himself to look up at Amaya's and Kudura's devastated faces. The terror hardens into a vow: no one else burns.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange, embers; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The phantom terror slowly forges into a heavy, suffocating vow. He couldn't let anyone else burn."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_14 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Vanglory strides over, all business: stay behind the perimeter. Are you the residents? Yama pushes the siblings gently behind him.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "This is an active scene, I need you all to stay behind the perimeter."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Are you... the residents?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I'll handle this."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_15 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama introduces himself as High Council, here to ensure the safety of council members Alia and Eldyn Hasan's children.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I'm Yama Amaruk, a member of the High Council, this is the home of council members Alia and Eldyn Hasan, these are their children. I came to ensure the safety of this family."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_16 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Vanglory steps into his space, hand near her holster, unintimidated: it's her city. Yama: this is beyond her. What did she find?
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: ""Yama... Amaruk." My intel mentioned this family was important. It didn't mention 'associates' showing up to my crime scenes giving orders."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "High Council or not, you're in my city, Amaruk. This is an active investigation of a fatal fire."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "This situation is far more complex than your investigation can handle, Inspector. What have you found?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_17 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** She relents and holds up the evidence bag with the blackened, empty amulet. She describes the body and the study shielded from the flames.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "One body. Charred beyond recognition. We found this beside it."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "And there's a section of the house, a study, completely untouched by the flames. As if it was shielded."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Yama? Do you know what this means?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_18 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama's jaw tightens. He knows the amulet was Eldyn's, a protective vessel spent to save one life at the cost of his own. Aloud, he says only to contact him.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "He knew what that amulet was. It belonged to Eldyn."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "No, but whatever you find out, please contact me immediately!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_19 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama kneels to the siblings and tells them: an attack. Their father used his power to protect their mother, and the body was his.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Amaya, Kudura... there was an attack."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "Are they...?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Listen to me... It's a lot to take in, but we need to keep this to ourselves right now, your father... He used his power to protect your mother. The body they found... it was his, he's gone."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_20 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Amaya crumples, sobbing. Otura catches her as she clutches the bag holding the Tome like an anchor.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "A strangled sob escaped Amaya's lips, and she crumpled, her legs giving way. Otura caught her."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_21 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Kudura stands rigid, fists clenched, dry-eyed. His eyes glow faint crimson as he stares into the inferno that was his home.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "His fists clenched. He didn't cry. His eyes, glowing with a faint crimson light, stared into the inferno that had been his home."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_22 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Otura blames himself and the book. Yama, sharp: not his fault. They are targets for who they are.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "This... this was because of the book... I shouldn't have let you take it. I'm so sorry."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "No, Otura."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "This is not your fault. The forces that did this were set in motion long before tonight. You are all targets now, not because of what you have, but because of who you are."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_23 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama's senses flare at a flicker of malevolent energy. He scans the rooftops and the crowd: whoever did this is still near. They're leaving.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "We're leaving. The ones who did this... they're still around here..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "What are you talking about?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c5_24 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama explains the mission: take the book, kill the bloodline, and it is only half done. Vanglory blocks his path. Yama: 'Your officers will die!'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "The mission had two parts - Acquire the book and eliminate the bloodline. They only partially succeeded in eliminating the bloodline."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "You need to evacuate everyone from this area. My priority is to protect the survivors."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "I can't just let you walk away with the victims! They are material witnesses. If there's an active threat, my officers need to secure them..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Your officers will die, Inspector!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c5_25 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama's aura flares like thunder and Vanglory instinctively steps back. This is a matter for the High Council and the Enforcers.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Listen to me. There is no time. This exceeds the capability of your police. It is imperative that you allow the High Council and Enforcers to take care of this matter before more of your people burn."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

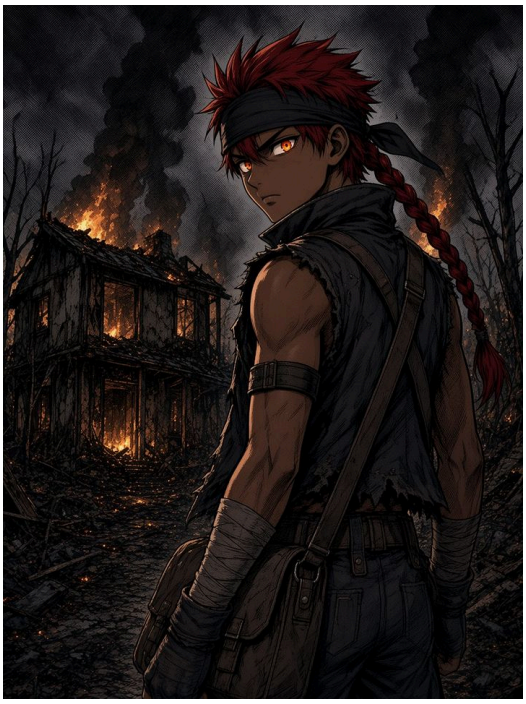
c5_26 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Outgunned, Vanglory radios Mendez to widen the perimeter, then lets them go, though she won't drop this.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Eva Vanglory `EVA_VANGLORY_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Chief Mendez, pull the men back. Establish a wider perimeter. We might have hostiles."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Vanglory**: "Get them out of here. But if you think I'm dropping this, you're dead wrong."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c5_27 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama's hands rest on the siblings' shoulders. Kudura takes one last look at the smoldering ruin, his eyes burning with a vow of vengeance. Otura recognizes the darkness.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange, embers; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "A silent vow was forged in that moment, a promise of vengeance written in ash and rage."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.



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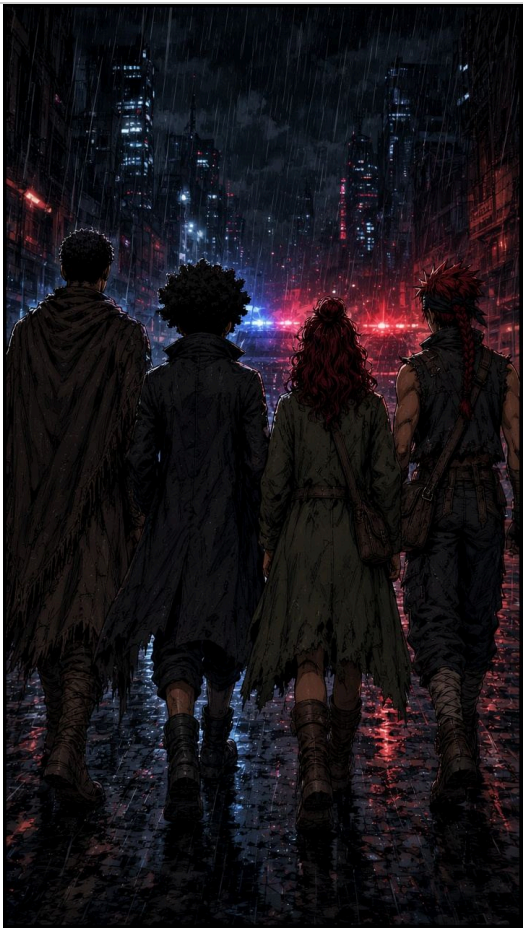
c5_28 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The four walk back into the drenched streets of Empire City: two broken families fused into something harder and more dangerous.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** neon purple/cyan, wet reflections; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`, Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "They were no longer just a guardian and his ward, or a boy and his friends."
- [CAPTION box]: "They were the broken remnants of two families, now fused by tragedy into something new, something harder, and something far more dangerous."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.



CHAPTER 6 · The Weight of Sanctuary · The Emporium: interior

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c6_01 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The heavy Emporium door swings shut, sealing in absolute silence, incense, and the smoke clinging to their clothes.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The heavy door of the Emporium swings shut, sealing the four of them inside."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_02 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Amaya stands frozen, eyes vacant. The bag holding the Tome slips from her numb fingers and thuds to the floor.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "The bag containing the Tome of Damnation slips from her numb fingers, hitting the floor with a soft thud."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_03 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The sound breaks her. Amaya collapses sobbing, and Otura kneels and wraps his arms around her.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "A gut-wrenching sob tears from Amaya's throat and she collapses. Otura rushes to her side, kneeling and wrapping his arms around her, though he knows no comfort is possible."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_04 (3:4) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Close-up: Kudura's face is stone, his eyes glowing crimson. He drives his fist into a solid metal pillar and dents it, unfazed.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
-
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_05 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama watches, weighed down by sorrow and failure, eyes closed, shoulders slumped. He apologizes for Eldyn and to Otura.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Amaya... Kudura... I am so sorry. Your father... Eldyn, was an exceptional man. And Otura... I am sorry you had to witness this."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I know... you need time. But you must also know this."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_06 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Quiet. Amaya's sobs are muffled in Otura's shoulder. Yama: they need time, but they must know this.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Amaya, Kudura. I vow on my life, I will find out who is responsible for tonight. Your mother... she is alive. The High Council is likely already searching for her. Someone will answer for this."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_07 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Close-up on Yama, eyes open and intense: he vows to find who did this. Their mother is alive.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "I... I couldn't feel her. Outside... there was nothing."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_08 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Amaya looks up, tear-streaked: she couldn't feel her. Kudura turns from the pillar, dangerously calm, with hope and bloodlust in his eyes. Yama must leave to convene with the Council.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "Are you sure she's alive, Yama?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Your mother is a high-ranking High Council member, I'm positive. And I will do my part to help locate her, which means I must leave to convene with the Council... you cannot stay here alone."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_09 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama's gaze sweeps the three, his tone shifting to grim necessity: the School of Ya'Oh is the only other warded place, and they'll go while he's away.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "The School of Ya'Oh is the only other place warded enough to keep you safe. You will all go while I am away."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_10 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Wide shot: Amaya stumbles to her feet, furious and despairing, and screams at Yama about school.
- **Shot:** WIDE · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "School?! How can you talk about SCHOOL?! My father is dead! My mother is missing! Our home is GONE! I can't... I can't do this, Kudura!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_11 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Kudura, cold, tells her to get it together. Close-up: Amaya, shocked and hurt, accuses him of letting power go to his head, and he snaps back.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "Amaya. Get it together."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "How can you say that to me?! You get a taste of power and suddenly you're better than us?! You think you're some big shot now?!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "At least I'm trying to get something done instead of sitting there crying about it!"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_12 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Dynamic shot: Yama steps between them and silences them with authority. Store that rage; we will need it. Amaya is confused.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Enough. Both of you have every right to your anger. To your grief. But I need you to hold onto it. Store that rage. We will have need of it."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Need of it? For what?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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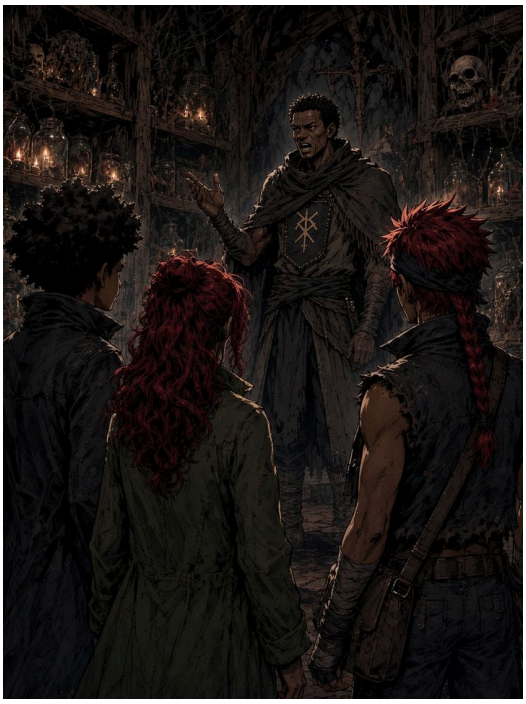
c6_13 (3:4)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama lays it out: training, control, strategy, fighting as a team among peers. Otura notes they aren't enrolled. It's arranged, and they go tomorrow.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "For your training. You must become strong. You must be able to defend yourselves in this world when I am not there to protect you."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "You will learn control, strategy, and how to fight as a team. After tonight, I've requested entry on your behalves to the elite training courses at the School of Ya'Oh."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "But we aren't even enrolled..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I have already made the arrangements. I will gather my strength and transport you all tomorrow."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c6_14 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Kudura's composure cracks: his father's remains? Yama nods solemnly and will retrieve them, knowing what that means to their bloodline.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "And my father? His remains..."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "I will retrieve them immediately. I know how important preserving the remains is to your bloodline."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c6_15 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Final panel, three-way split: Otura's quiet resolve, Amaya on the sofa with grief hardening into resentment, Kudura apart with fists clenched, lost in vengeance. Yama sends them to the guest rooms.
- **Shot:** SPLIT PANEL · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`, Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Otura, show Kudura and Amaya where the guest rooms are and get some rest. We have long days ahead of us."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_16 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Morning. Yama cooks, then sets breakfast on the table: eat fast, bring your combat gear, first day at Ya'Oh.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** pale morning light; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Skip to morning"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Otura, Kudura, Amaya, breakfast's ready, eat as quickly as possible as I'll be transporting you all for your first day at the School of Ya'Oh. Be sure to bring your combat gear."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c6_17 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The trio gears up. Kudura is ready. Amaya eyes her book, deciding, and brings it. Otura drags behind.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "I'm ready."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Almost finished!"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Otura**: "Yeah... Coming."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c6_18 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Yama casts a spell in a mystic circle and a portal opens on the floor. The three gather around it.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Come to the living room when you all finish breakfast, we'll transport right away."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Follow me, don't worry, it's safe."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_19 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Low-angle wide shot: the towering, ancient gates of the School of Ya'Oh in bright, ethereal morning light through mist. Temple architecture, energy shielding, and a glowing barrier humming in the sky.
- **Shot:** LOW ANGLE · **Lighting/mood:** pale morning light; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** none (environment / FX)
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [CAPTION box]: "Gates of the School of Ya'Oh · Morning"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "Welcome to the blessed School of Ya'Oh."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_20 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** The trio steps out of the fading purple portal with their combat gear. Otura is in awe with his fro in the breeze, Amaya clutches her book, and Kudura narrows his eyes at the tactical layout.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`, Amaya Hasan (17) `AMAYA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`
- **Lettering:** none (silent panel)
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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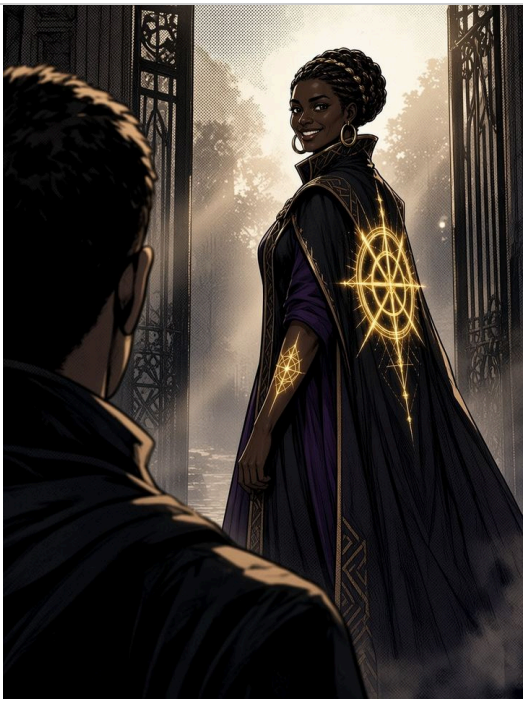
c6_21 (3:4)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Over Otura's shoulder: Head Chancellor Gaya at the entrance, with immense spiritual pressure and a welcoming posture. She greets Yama and the emergency transfers.
- **Shot:** OVER-THE-SHOULDER · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Gaya `GAYA_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Gaya**: "Yama Amaruk. It is rare to see the Emporium's master walking the grounds. And these must be the emergency transfers you requested."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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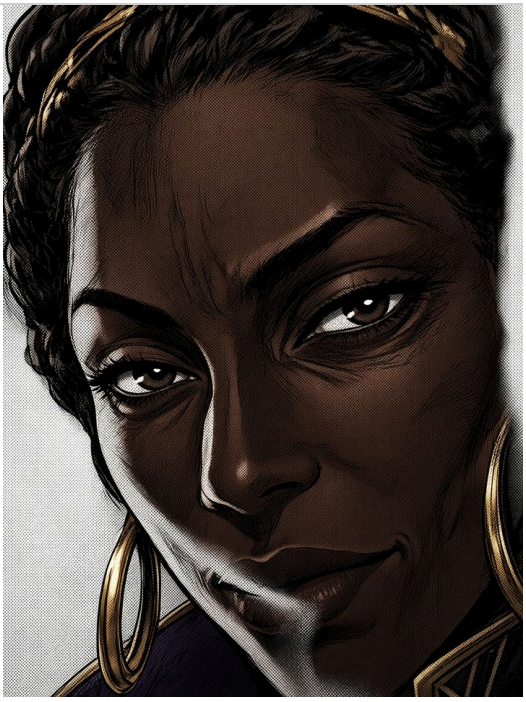
c6_22 (3:4)



- **Beat (from story prose):** Close-up: Gaya's knowing, ancient eyes scan the three and linger a fraction longer on Otura.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Gaya `GAYA_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Gaya**: "There is heavy grief clinging to you three. But behind these gates, you will find only focus."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

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c6_23 (16:9)

- **Beat (from story prose):** A weary Yama tells them this is where they part. Gaya will handle dorms and branding. Amaya: 'Branding?'
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Yama Amaruk `YAMA_AMARUK_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Yama**: "This is where we part ways for now. Chancellor Gaya will arrange your dormitories and your branding."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Amaya**: "Branding?"
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_24 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Close-up: Gaya pulls back her sleeve to reveal the glowing Sygil of Ya'Oh on her forearm, a mandatory protective ward.
- **Shot:** CLOSE-UP · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Gaya `GAYA_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Gaya**: "The Sygil of Ya'Oh. It is a mandatory protective ward. Without it, you cannot survive the training grounds... nor can you be trusted by the Galactic Enforcers."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_25 (3:4)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Kudura is unbothered: do it. Otura nervously touches Death's Pendant hidden under his shirt. Gaya (off-panel): first, an evaluation.
- **Shot:** MEDIUM · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kudura Hasan (17) `KUDURA_HASAN_17.jpg`, Otura (17) `OTURA_LIGHTBRINGER_17.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kudura**: "Do it. Whatever it takes to get stronger."
- [SPEECH balloon] **Gaya**: "Good. But before you settle in, we must evaluate where you stand."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_26 (9:16) · ACTION

- **Beat (from story prose):** Low-angle dynamic shot: a shockwave cracks across the courtyard. Gozu, the hulking golem sentinel juggernaut, is hurled through the air into a stone pillar. KRA-KOOM!
- **Shot:** LOW ANGLE · **Lighting/mood:** low-key, heavy black ink shadows; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Gozu `GOZU_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **GORE (full intended):** Uncensored. Show wounds, blood spray, and impact damage at full horror intensity, with heavy speed lines and smear frames. Do not soften to match the reference.
- **Lettering (in order):**
-
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.

---

c6_27 (9:16)

- **Beat (from story prose):** Full-body reveal: Kano (one horn, hellfire in his hands, cocky smirk) stands where Gozu was thrown from. Gaya: the first evaluation is surviving the yard.
- **Shot:** FULL BODY · **Lighting/mood:** firelight orange, embers; gritty dark-horror ink
- **Characters:** Kano `KANO_AGE_UNKNOWN.jpg`
- **Lettering (in order):**
- [SPEECH balloon] **Kano**: "Boring. Isn't there anyone in this school who can actually take a punch?"
- [SPEECH balloon] **Gaya**: "Your first evaluation will be surviving the yard."
- **Continuity:** keep faces clear of balloons; match outfits to the card refs above.